

ogy at major and also other stations like Chhapra, Gonda, Gorakhpur, Kathgodam, Ramnager and is being extended to remaining stations. Improved lighting standards have revolutionized the get up of stations.

MOBILE CHARGING FACILITY is being provided at stations, waiting halls, trains.

ISO CERTIFICATION:

N.E. Rly is consistently improving the quality of coaches, their up-keep and passenger comfort during the run. Coaches are being maintained to highest standard for the benefit of the passengers. N.E. Railway is proud to get ISO-14000 for some of prestigious trains.



ADDITIONAL COACHES are being provided to cater for passenger requirement.

FACILITY OF PRS AND UTS for quick dispensing of tickets is being provided to remote stations of this railway. So far 79 PRS locations (128 counters) and 10 UTS locations (72 counters) are already in operation and in 07-09 most of the stations will be provided with this facility.

ENQUIRY has been one of the weakest areas where passengers have been facing problem in getting timely and correct information. N.E. Rly has taken number of steps to achieve improvement in this area of information. IVRS & NTES are being provided for getting correct and timely information. Latest technology is being used extensively to meet ever rising expectations as a result touch screen has been provided for dispensing information. ATMs are being provided at stations for easy dispensation of cash. Cyber cafe has been provided for best utilization of time and free flow of information.

SECURITY: Highest attention is being paid to security of esteemed passengers. RPF & GRP are operating at stations and in trains to ensure necessary security of passengers at stations and in transit. Taking the passenger safely to their destinations is our motto. N.E. Rly is working to improve safety to the esteemed passengers. N.E. Rly feels happy and proud to provide safe journey during 2006-07 and 2007-08 marching ahead.

N.E. Railway has committed team of officers and staff led by dynamic leader, Shri Sukhbir Singh, General Manager. His vibrant team is committed to meet the goals and objectives set by Minister for Railways and provide best comfort to esteemed passengers in the shortest possible time. N.E. Rly pledges to provide still better comfort in immediate future. I wish them good luck.

INTERVIEW ■ SHRI SUKHBIR SINGH

Shri Sukhbir Singh (the gold medallist from Roorkee University, Electrical Engineering 1972 batch, and who joined the Indian Railways in 1972) the man responsible for bringing revolutionary changes in North Eastern Railway (NER) in an informal chat told that the NER got unprecedented success because of the able leadership of Shri Lalu Prasad Yadav, Minister for Railways.



SHRI SUKHBIR SINGH
GM, N.E.R.

Question: What is the reason behind this transformation?

Answer: I led my team instead of becoming their boss. My primary responsibility is towards my staff. I listened to all the problems of my staff and tried to provide an appropriate solution immediately. I tried to make my decision-making skill faster. I usually take quick decision anyway. I am available to my staff 24 hours a day. Now, decisions are not taken sitting in our NER office. All the officers including me keep inspecting the entire NER area because of which there is direct interaction between the management and workers. This in turn enables us to take decision on the spot. I myself remain on round for 20-22 days. Besides now in the colonies of our NER staff clean environment, fresh water and good roads are available. Before I joined the hospitals of NER were in shambles. Now all the hospitals are working actively. The private practice of the doctors of NER has stopped. For our workers, working away from the head office, mobile medical hospitals are available which go to the workers in their fields, examine and treat them there. This mobile medical team reports to me directly. When I joined there were 200 cases pending of the dependents of the deceased who were recruited within one month. Today it is my clear instruction that the dependents be recruited within one month of the death of the worker. Apart from this now all the railway staff gets all their related income on the day of their retirement itself. Because of all these reasons the entire team of NER is self-inspired to put in their best. The result is the once non-efficient NER has now transformed into the most efficient railway of India.

Question: What is so special about your working style?

Answer: Discipline is my first priority. The policy of rewarding the honest and punctual workers while punishing the indiscipline is the basis of my success. Apart from this I have taken special care to increase the income of NER. Today the income from goods train of NER has increased by 37 percent while it is just 20 percent for the entire Indian railways. At the same time looking at the heavy on flow of travelers in all the major trains of NER, 24 bogeys are being used. Special attention is being paid to the cleanliness of railway stations.